

Cipher

Displays or alters the encryption of folders and files on NTFS volumes. Used without parameters, cipher displays the encryption state of the current folder and any files it contains.

Syntax:

```
cipher [{ /e|/d}] [ /s:dir] [ /a] [ /i] [ /f] [ /q] [ /h]  
[ /k] [ /u [ /n]] [ PathName [ ...]] |  
[ /r:PathNameWithoutExtension] | [ /w:PathName]
```

/e: Encrypts the specified folders. Folders are marked so that files that are added to the folder later are encrypted too.

/d: Decrypts the specified folders. Folders are marked so that files that are added to the folder later are encrypted too.

/s: dir: Performs the selected operation in the specified folder and all subfolders.

/a: Performs the operation for files and directories.

/i: Continues performing the specified operation even after errors occur. By default, cipher stops when it encounters an error.

/f: Forces the encryption or decryption of all specified objects. By default, cipher skips files that have been encrypted or decrypted already.

/q: Reports only the most essential information.

/h: Displays files with hidden or system attributes. By default, these files are not encrypted or decrypted.

/k: Creates a new file encryption key for the user running cipher. If you use this option, cipher ignores all of the other options.

/u: Updates the user's file encryption key or recovery agent's key to the current ones in all of the encrypted files on local drives (that is, if the keys have been changed). This option only works with **/n**.

/n: Prevents keys from being updated. Use this option to find all of the encrypted files on the local drives. This option only works with **/u**.

PathName: Specifies a pattern, file, or folder.

/r: PathNameWithoutExtension: Generates a new recovery agent certificate and private key, and then writes them to files